Levels of Supervision: Dysphagia Evaluation

It is important for SLPs to use standardized definitions for each level of supervision selected for patients with dysphagia. The options in Rehab Optima are based on the Dysphagia Outcome and Severity Scale and FIM definitions.

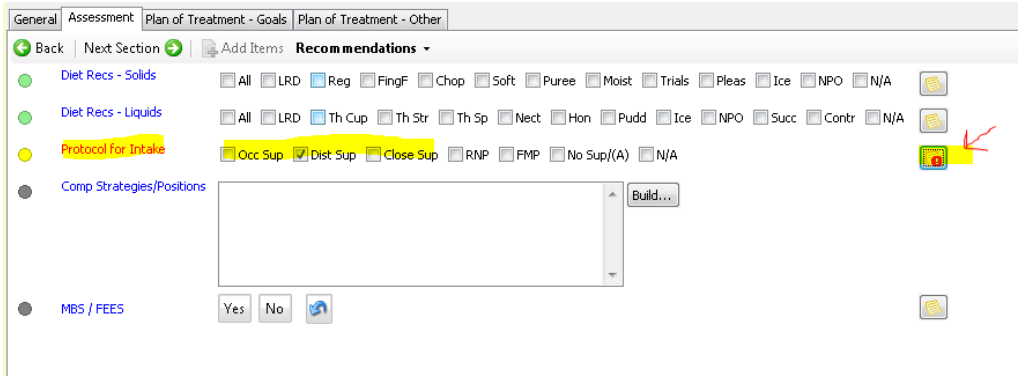
Standardized definitions for supervision:

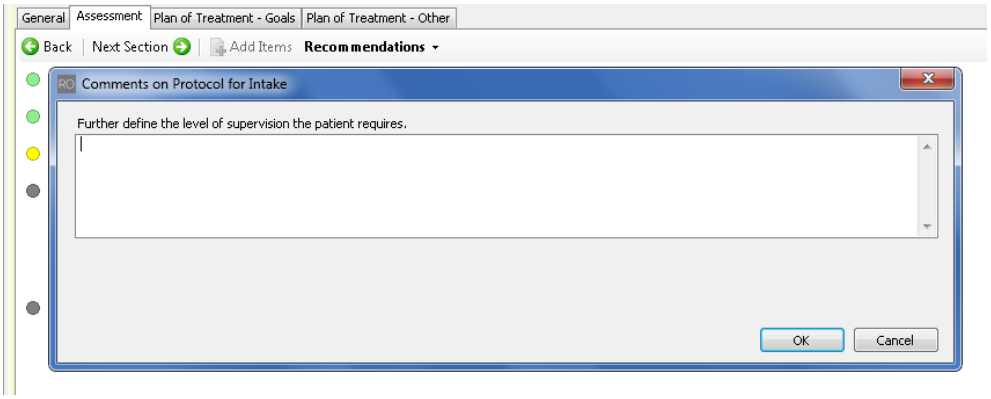
Occasional Supervision: No assist needed, however, patient uses adaptive equipment, durable medical equipment, adaptive strategy/technique or increased time.

Distant Supervision: Requires help to be within hearing distance of patient for intermittent cues as needed.

Close Supervision: Requires verbal cues and patient is within sight of helper.

Rehab Optima now requires the SLP to provide additional information when the level of supervision is selected.





The SLPs can enter definitions in this box in addition to adding other recommendations related to swallow supervision.

It is recommended that the levels of supervision are trained and clarified with the clinical team. If the levels of supervision are indicated on the care plan – it may be helpful to include the definition for additional clarity.